

Technical covariate balance within each differential comparison

Dashed line: the median |SMD| produced by chance alone at that comparison's group sizes (5000 label permutations).

Points near or below it are what balanced groups look like at $n = 3-8$. Dotted line marks the $|SMD| = 0.25$ convention, which does not apply at these sample sizes.

samples ● 10 ● 15 ● 20 ● 25 ● not distinguishable from chance

